

TRIBAL INDIA

L-63 Class Notes | Paper 2 | Handout 4

Ch 6.3 R&R Problems

Ch 7.1 Constitutional Safeguards

Ch 7.2 Social Change

Ch 9.1 Development Programmes

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CHAPTER 6.3 — PROBLEMS OF REHABILITATION & RESETTLEMENT

R&R ISSUES

Land Identification

Land Records

PAP Identification

Loss of Livelihood

Loss of Home

Stakeholder Exclusion

Grievance Redressal

Key Context: R&R has been a burning issue since **pre-independence**. Post-1947, India took the path of development through massive infrastructure — **large multipurpose river valley projects, thermal power projects, mining of minerals, construction of roads and development of industrial hubs** — all requiring large tracts of land, causing **involuntary acquisition of land and involuntary displacement**. PAPs estimated at **50–100 million** persons. No reliable data on how many resettled or rehabilitated.

PRINCIPLE: RESETTLEMENT vs REHABILITATION

Aspect	Resettlement	Rehabilitation
Definition	Spatial adjustment — moving people from original homes to another place (for dam, mine, factory, sanctuary)	Holistic restoration — restoring the economic, social & cultural well-being of displaced people
Focus	<i>Where</i> to move them — physical relocation only	<i>How</i> they live after — livelihood, dignity, standard of living
Nature	A logistical exercise : count families, allot plots, move them. Social & cultural losses ignored	Goes beyond relocation: livelihood training, education, healthcare, participation in planning
Compensation	Authorities promise land-for-land or house-for-house, but in reality only physical relocation happens	National R&R Policy, 2007 emphasizes minimizing displacement and ensuring people live better than before
Problem	People lose their livelihoods, culture, and belonging which are rarely restored	Key idea: helping them regain livelihood, dignity, and standard of living through training & participation

Example: When tribals are moved from **forests to plains**, their **farming, food habits, and spiritual ties to nature** break down, disrupting their traditional life completely. The **Hirakud Dam Project (1950s, Odisha)** displaced 22,000+ families with little rehabilitation — this later shaped national R&R policies.

7 KEY R&R ISSUES (IN DETAIL)

1. Identification of Land to be Acquired

- Government uses **law of 'eminent domain'** — absolute right to acquire any private land for public purpose
- It implies what is good for the **larger section** of society can be done at the cost of the small section of land oustees
- Projects involve acquisition of **forest land as well as agriculture land**
- Projects like **mining and hydro-electric** cannot be shifted due to geological requirements, but a little compromise on the **mining boundary** or submergence level could **substantially reduce the number of PAPs**
- Question: Should PAPs only be displaced, or also **compensated and supported** for their rehabilitation and resettlement?

2. Land Records & Payment of Compensation

- Land is a state subject** — records related to land ownership are kept by the **Patwari** of the village
- Records are **rarely updated** — supposed to be updated every 30 years, which itself is a long period
- Difficult to assess the **real value of land** as assessment is based on the **last traded value**
- This creates hurdles in deciding compensation, resulting in **legal claims that continue in courts for decades**

- **Forest dwellers** who are displaced have **no land records** available → making them **ineligible for compensation**. The compensation that is paid remains **meagre**

3. Identification of Project Affected Persons (PAPs)

- A major hurdle when: (i) land owners are **not traceable** due to non-updated records or **not residing** in the area
- (ii) People **do not own land** but cultivate it on sharing basis or work as **daily wage earners** for cultivation
- (iii) Some have been cultivating forest land for **generations** but **do not have land in their name**
- (iv) **Outsiders** buy a small piece of land to claim R&R benefits and enroll as PAPs (fraud)

4. Loss of Livelihoods

- Not merely a **monetary loss** — what is equally important is the **style of earning that livelihood**
- **Land** provides the essential **economic security** even for taking a loan in case of emergency
- Harvested crop is used for **bartering** to meet other needs
- Cultivation provides **food security**
- The **traditional wisdom and skills** of agricultural practices are **passed on through generations** — no formal education or training required
- Loss of land results in their skill and knowledge harnessed over decades becoming **redundant in one go**

5. Loss of Home

- Resettlement into a new area creates its **own complexities**
- Issues of **ecological incompatibility** — resettled area in stark contrast to their original environment
- **Non-availability of opportunities for traditional livelihood** forces them into alien occupations (agricultural & industrial labourers), disrupting their lifestyle
- Resettling in a **non-familiar environment** will **alienate them from the host community** resulting in hostility
- In many cases, the **resettled population was not entitled to legal rights** over the land in the resettled area

6. Lack of Stakeholder Engagement, Loss of Dignity & Self-Respect

- PAPs are often **illiterate** but have **traditional wisdom, self-respect and dignity**
- Since they don't speak corporate language, it is assumed they are **not wise enough to take decisions** about their own lives — hence stakeholder engagement is denied
- All **decisions** made by **project authorities** and **local government** are **imposed** on them, assuming it is for their good and welfare

7. The Grievance Redressal Mechanism

- In the absence of **genuine grievance redressal**, PAPs get lost as to whom to approach
- Ultimately, PAPs lose **trust** in the entire **process of land acquisition and R&R**

CASE STUDIES — R&R

Baiga Gond Kanha Tiger Reserve, MP Forced Relocation (2015)

January 2015: ~450 Baiga and Gond settlements relocated under a **forest conservation and rehabilitation program**. Criticized as **forced eviction** despite government claiming it was a **voluntary relocation** aimed at providing **better facilities and livelihoods** outside the reserve.

Jenu Kuruba Soliga Mysuru, Karnataka Rehabilitation Delay (2020)

2020: Adivasi groups protested delays in **rehabilitation deeds & land title** after displacement from forest areas. Issues: **non-declaration of tribal hamlets as revenue villages**, lack of **land allotment under Mastigudi rehabilitation**, and **diversion of funds** by dominant groups. ~210 families, mainly Jenu Kuruba and Soliga, were affected. Appeals made to **National Commission for Scheduled Tribes** for justice.

Hirakud Dam, Odisha (1950s) Early R&R Failure

22,000+ families displaced with little rehabilitation. This failure later shaped better national R&R policies.

SOLUTIONS FOR R&R (COMPREHENSIVE)

Key Principle: The sustainable restoration of livelihood not only requires restoration of regular **monetary income** but also extends the **opportunities to PAPs to utilize their full potential while maintaining their dignity**. Restoration of livelihoods needs **careful planning** and **intense engagement with the PAPs** to make them **psychologically prepared** for the change.

A. Solutions with respect to Rehabilitation

Solution	Details	Example / Notes
1. Land for Land	The obvious first and best choice since it assures restoration of income in the original lifestyle	Rourkela Steel Plant (1956): 30 villages mainly inhabited by Oraon, Kharia, and Bhumij tribes were displaced. They were resettled within 5 km of their original villages with land and houses in new colonies . This helped them stay connected to their old community networks.
2. Self-Employment Schemes	The most available and viable option due to increase in demand for goods and services with inflow of project-dependent population. Common schemes: carpet weaving, masala grinding, bamboo crafting, dairy, poultry, carpentry, goat rearing, apiculture (bee keeping), sericulture (silkworm rearing), pisciculture (fish farming), handicraft	However, lack of education, skills and entrepreneurship abilities may also affect the viability of this option. Formal training and mentoring needed.
3. Employment in the Project	Regular employment not only addresses the restoration of previous standard of living but provides significant improvement , making this alternative the most sought after	Ho community in Singhbhum, Jharkhand employed in Zinc Factory . The work brought different clans together, created social unity , and improved economic condition. However, exposure to outsiders also changed some traditions — like restrictions on dancing and singing during the Maghe festival . So while development brought jobs, it also transformed their culture.

B. Solutions with respect to Resettlement

- There have been several instances where PAPs have **rejected fully developed resettlement colonies**, sometimes **even with the built-up houses**
- 6 Factors** that impact PAP's decision to select or reject the resettlement colony:

#	Factor
1	Access to livelihood opportunities
2	Access to market
3	Access to health and education facilities
4	Availability of space for storing fodder and grains and shelter for domestic animals
5	Availability of space for expanding the house in future as the family expands
6	Availability of community land for pasture, fodder, village pond, wells, trees, celebrating festivals

Key Quote: The restoration of livelihood is not merely in monetary terms alone. People aspire to restore the **process of earning** that livelihood. They need much **empathy** rather than **sympathy**. PAPs should be given opportunities to settle at the **place of their choice** other than the resettlement colony.

CHAPTER 7.1 — CONSTITUTIONAL PROVISIONS FOR SCHEDULED TRIBES

Context: STs are **backward socially and economically**. Several provisions have been incorporated in the Constitution for safeguarding and promoting the interests and rights of STs in various spheres to enable them to join the national mainstream. The purpose is to **accelerate their socio-economic development**.

Indicators of ST Backwardness

ST BACKWARDNESS INDICATORS

High IMR (41.6)

Low Literacy (59%)

Below Poverty Line (BPL)

Less Land Access

Low Income (subsistence)

Social Indicators

- **Infant Mortality Rate (IMR)** — High among tribals. Barring a few NE tribal groups, most have low literacy rates.

NFHS Data: ST Progress (2005-06 to 2019-21)

Indicator	2005-06	2019-21	Change
Infant Mortality Rate	62.1	41.6	▼ Improved
Under-5 Mortality Rate	95.7	50.3	▼ Improved
Institutional Delivery	17.7%	82.3%	▲ Improved
Immunization (12-23 months)	31.3%	76.8%	▲ Improved

Economic Indicators

- **Below Poverty Line (BPL)** — Despite govt measures, majority of tribals are below the poverty line
- **Access to Land** — FRA 2006 tried to give land rights, but due to **high rejection rate and less land being granted**, they own less land compared to plains counterparts
- **Average Income** — Due to non-modern practices (no chemical fertilizers, no HYV seeds), limited access to land, produce is just enough for **subsistence and not for sale in market**

CONSTITUTIONAL SAFEGUARDS FOR STs

Category	Article	Provision
Foundation	Preamble	Socialist/Justice — Social, Economic, Political equality of status & opportunity; to promote fraternity assuring dignity of the individual
Notification	342	President may declare a group as STs via notification
Definition	366(25)	Definition of Scheduled Tribes
Educational, Economic & Employment (Part II-B)	15	Prohibition of discrimination on grounds of religion, race, caste, sex, place of birth
	16	Equality of opportunity in matters of public employment
	19	Protection of certain rights regarding freedom of speech

	46	Promotion of educational and economic interest of SCs, STs and other weaker sections
	335	Claims of SCs and STs to services and posts
Political (Part II-C)	330	Reservation of seats — Lok Sabha (House of People)
	332	Reservation — State Legislative Assemblies
	334	Reservation & special representation to cease after 10 years (extended periodically)
	243D / 243T	Reservation in Panchayats / Municipalities
Monitoring (Part II-D)	338A	National Commission for Scheduled Tribes (NCST) — oversee implementation of provisions and safeguards

Special Provisions — Schedules & State Articles

Provision	Details
Fifth Schedule (Art. 244(1))	Scheduled Areas ; provides for establishment of Tribal Advisory Council (TAC) in any state having scheduled areas; Union govt gives executive directions to states regarding administration of Scheduled Areas
Sixth Schedule (Art. 244(2))	Special provisions for tribal areas in 4 NE states (Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram); Autonomous District Councils with legislative, judicial and executive powers
Art. 164(1)	Minister in charge of tribal welfare in Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, MP, Odisha (who may also be in charge of SC and backward classes welfare)
Art. 371(A/B/C/F)	Special provisions: Nagaland (A) / Assam (B) / Manipur (C) / Sikkim (F)

Legislative Measures

- **SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989** (amended 2016, 2018) — prevent atrocities and hate crimes; stricter punishment for offenses
- **Forest Rights Act (FRA), 2006** — The Scheduled Tribes and Other Forest Dwellers (Recognition of Forest Rights) Act
- **Bonded Labour System (Abolition) Act, 1976**

IDENTIFICATION OF SCHEDULED TRIBES

Lokur Committee (1965) — 5 Criteria for ST Identification

#	Criterion	Explanation
1	Indications of primitive traits	Pre-agricultural economy, simple technology
2	Distinctive culture	Unique customs, traditions, folklore
3	Geographical isolation	Living in remote, inaccessible areas
4	Shyness of contact with larger community	Limited interaction with mainstream society
5	General backwardness	Low literacy, poor health, economic deprivation

Criticism (2014 Task Force, Hrusikesh Panda): Lokur criteria found **obsolete, rigid & condescending**. Terms like "primitive" and "shy" fail to reflect present realities where many tribal communities have undergone cultural change and modernization. Further issues: **Lack of anthropological and sociological expertise** in decision-making bodies; **Inconsistent historical records** (varying census descriptions — from "tribal animists" in 1901 to "primitive tribes" in 1931); **Administrative inconsistencies** such as differing tribal names across states, exclusions due to state bifurcation or forced migration, and delays in updating lists.

Panda Committee — Proposed 5 New Criteria

#	New Criterion	Why Better
1	Socio-economic and educational backwardness relative to state's population	Measurable, not subjective
2	Historical geographical isolation , whether continuing or not	Acknowledges migration while respecting history
3	Distinct language or dialect	Objective cultural marker
4	Core cultural identity (life-cycle rituals, art, folklore, marriage customs)	Captures living culture, not museum traits
5	Endogamy (marriage largely within community)	Demonstrates group distinctiveness

To be assessed **holistically**, not individually. A modern, socio-culturally sensitive framework focusing on **backwardness, cultural continuity, and inclusion**.

Procedure for Inclusion in ST List

- 1 Proposal from **State Government / UT**
- 2 Review by **Ministry of Tribal Affairs (MoTA)**
- 3 Evaluation by **Registrar General of India (RGI)**
- 4 Recommendation by **National Commission for Scheduled Tribes (NCST)**
- 5 **Cabinet Approval**
- 6 **Presidential Assent** to amend Constitution (ST Order, 1950)

CASE STUDIES — TRIBAL EXPLOITATION

Chenchu (PVTG) **Karimnagar, Telangana** **Bonded Labour Rescue (2018-2020)**

2018: **45 Chenchu tribals** rescued from bonded labour at a canal irrigation site. Two years later, **12 survivors** received **₹1.5 lakh each** under **Centrally Sponsored Rehabilitation Scheme for Bonded Labour (1978, revised 2016)**. The case highlights how **Art. 23** and the **Bonded Labour System (Abolition) Act, 1976** protect tribal workers, though **delayed compensation & weak enforcement** remain persistent issues.

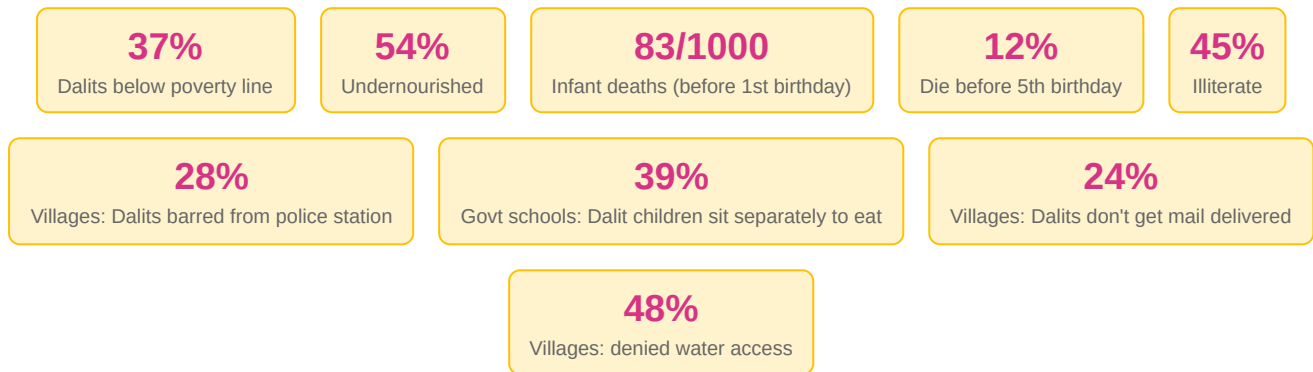
Paniya **Kattunayakan** **Adiya** **Nilambur, Kerala** **Child Labour (2023)**

2023: Reports from the **Nilambur region** along the **Malappuram-Kozhikode border** revealed that **tribal children aged 8-15**, mainly from the **Paniya, Kattunayakan, and Adiya tribes**, were employed in **areca nut and banana plantations** near Kakkadampoyil. They earned **₹300-500 per day** for clearing fields. Poverty, alcoholism, lack of educational follow-up led to **school dropouts** and child labour, violating **Articles 23 and 24** of the Constitution. The banned **CPI (Maoist)** expressed **solidarity with workers of the Plantation Corporation of Kerala (PCK)**, alleging forced overtime and wage neglect. Police suspected this was to **garner tribal support** by exploiting legitimate labour grievances. This case illustrates how **economic exploitation and educational neglect** among marginalized tribal communities can create conditions for **child labour and extremist influence**, underscoring the need for **holistic rehabilitation, community-based education, and stronger tribal welfare monitoring**.

CHAPTER 7.1 — EXPLOITATION & DISCRIMINATION OF SCHEDULED CASTES

NHRC 2010 Report: Crime against Dalits every **18 minutes**. Every day, on average: **3 Dalit women raped, 2 Dalits murdered, 2 Dalit houses burnt**.

NHRC Statistics (compiled by K.R. Saxena)



6 FORMS OF UNTOUCHABILITY (IN DETAIL)

#	Practice	Details
1	No Physical Contact	SCs did not participate in village meetings and worship . They lived in a separate hamlet . Their children did not attend school and play with children of higher castes. They had to play drums to pass through village streets.
2	Ban on Common Wells/Tanks	SCs were not allowed to use common village wells and tanks for fetching water. They had separate wells and ponds or depended on the courtesy of some to pour water.
3	Temple Entry Prohibited	SCs were not allowed to enter the temple for offering worship. Not supposed to hear religious discourses , offer prayer, or study religious texts.
4	Service Denial	Priests, artisan castes, dhobi (washermen) and dom (death ritual performers) did not render their services to persons of untouchable SC castes.
5	Food/Water Rejection	Food cooked by SCs was not accepted by higher castes. Water from the hands of SCs was also not acceptable .
6	Status Incongruence & Dependence	Persistence of stigma of untouchability and the Constitutional status of SCs were not congruent . They were dependent upon others for livelihood and survival.

CASE STUDIES — SC DISCRIMINATION

Gunnaur, UP Denial of Water (2016)

A **13-year-old Dalit girl** and her father were **beaten by a temple priest** in **Gunnaur village, Uttar Pradesh**, after she tried to drink from a temple hand pump. The priest called her caste names and denied her water, reflecting the **continued social exclusion and ban on Dalits using common wells and tanks**. Case registered under **Sections 323, 324 and 3(1)(10) of the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act**.

Sukhidhang, Champawat, Uttarakhand Food Boycott (2022)

May 2022: Students from a government school in **Sukhidhang village, Champawat district (Uttarakhand)** once again **boycotted midday meals** cooked by **Sunita, a Dalit bhojan mata**. Earlier in 2021, her appointment had sparked protests by parents of upper caste students who refused to eat food prepared by her. Despite being reinstated after filing a case under the **SC/ST (PoA) Act**, a few students continued the boycott. The incident reflects the persistent caste-based prejudice where **food and water handled by SCs remain socially unacceptable**, violating principles of **equality and human dignity**.

Cuddalore, Tamil Nadu Dalit Panchayat Chief Discrimination (2020)

October 2020: **Rajeshwari Saravana Kumar**, a **Dalit panchayat president** of Therku Thittai Panchayat, Cuddalore district, was **forced to sit on the floor** during panchayat meetings, while caste Hindu members sat on chairs. She was **barred from hoisting the national flag** and **prevented from using her official seat**. Following public outrage and viral photos, the **panchayat secretary was suspended**, and a case filed against the vice-president under **Section 3(1)(r) of the SC/ST (PoA) Act**. Exposes **deep-rooted caste discrimination in local governance**.

Thiruvallur, Tamil Nadu Flag Hoisting Denied (2023)

August 2023: **Dalit woman panchayat president of Aathupakkam Panchayat** (Thiruvallur district) was **prevented from hoisting the national flag** during Independence Day celebrations at a local school by a **former panchayat president and his supporters**. Following media reports, the **District Collector intervened** and organized a **special flag-hoisting ceremony** at the panchayat office, reaffirming the principle of **constitutional equality and dignity** for marginalized leaders.

Bihar Jitan Ram Manjhi Temple Incident (2014)

In 2014, a temple in Bihar was reportedly **cleaned and its idol washed** after **Dalit Chief Minister Jitan Ram Manjhi** visited. This demonstrates that Dalits face **discrimination even when they hold the highest political positions** — a key argument against applying the creamy layer concept to SC/STs.

FACTORS OF SC EXPLOITATION (COMPREHENSIVE)

Category	Factor	Details
Social Factors	Deep-rooted caste system	4 Varnas by birth in Hinduism; discrimination of the Shudras and outcastes/ chandalas depriving them of social intercourse, educational and cultural development . Stigma strengthened through the religious concept of " ritual purity "
	Rigid & biased religious literature	Restrictions placed on who should and shouldn't read Vedas . Dalits and Women were not permitted to read the Vedas.
	Psychological factors	Dalits consider themselves inferior and tolerate exploitation psychologically in the name of religion
	Lack of social awareness	Illiteracy : SC literacy level only 66.1% vs national 73%. Female literacy only 56.5% vs national 64.6% (Census 2011)
Economic Factors	Unclean occupations	In occupations such as leather work and sweeping , SCs are in a majority. UP : Of 46,000 leather workers, 41,000 are from castes like Chamars, Dhusia, Jatava . Rajasthan : Of 76,000 sweepers, 52,000 belong to Bhangi, Mehtar, Chura
	Lack of land	SCs did not own land for residence and agriculture. They lived in huts on the master's land and worked as agricultural labour as good as bonded labour . Dependence on dominant castes for livelihood needs.
Political Factors	Lack of representation	 Ajit Donker & Saxena (2012) : Out of 1000 firms (private & public), 93% board members from upper castes , 3.8% from backward castes , 3.5% from SC/ST. Political reservation leads to backlash .
Other Causes of Exploitation	Reservation — relaxation and concessions in favor of SCs trigger resentment; Demolition/forcible occupation of houses/shops of SCs; Charges of theft/looting/dacoity against SCs; Misusing official persons for harassing SC persons; Illicit relations between members of SC and non-SC; Disputes over drainage and other problems	

CURRENT ISSUES & DALIT POLITICS

- **Discrimination in educational institutions** — Remember **Rohit Vemula** case? 🖋️ **Sukhdeo Thorat Committee** addressed educational institution discrimination
- **Dalit politics** typically takes two forms:

Type	Details
Militant Movements	Bhim Sena — caused more reactionary measures from caste Hindus. Violence-based approach proved counterproductive.
Electoral Coalitions	Apart from BSP in UP , not many Dalit parties have succeeded because the spread of Dalit population is such that by themselves they are always in a minority . In any electoral battle, they can only benefit if they form an alliance with other dominant caste groups, or mainstream political parties . Successful Dalit parties: Lok Janshakti Party (Bihar, 2000, Ram Vilas Paswan) and Viduthalai Puratchi Party (VPP) (Tamil Nadu, 1989, Thol. Thirumavalavan) — both representing Dalit interests and pursuing social justice based on Dr. B.R. Ambedkar's principles .

CURRENT INITIATIVES FOR SC WELFARE

Domain	Initiative	Details
Legislative	SC/ST (PoA) Act 1989	Prevent atrocities & hate crimes; Amended 2016 & 2018 to strengthen legal provisions, emphasizing stricter punishment for offenses
	Supreme Court (Oct 2021)	Justices Dhananjaya Y Chandrachud & BV Nagarathna: "Atrocities against SCs and STs are not a thing of the past . They continue to be a reality in our society even today. Hence the statutory provisions must be complied with and enforced conscientiously ."
Economic	Startup India / MUDRA	Empower SCs through entrepreneurship by providing financial support, mentoring, and access to markets
	Dalit Entrepreneur Hub	Focuses on fostering entrepreneurship within Dalit community, offering support for business development and growth
Political	Sukhdeo Thorat Committee	Addressing educational institution discrimination — constitutionally guaranteed safeguards should be adhered to prevent hostility against "students of reserved category"
	Bhopal Declaration (2001/2)	Dalit rights charter
	Better Implementation of SC/ST Act	Efforts for stricter enforcement, awareness campaigns , and mechanisms for reporting and addressing grievances
	Dalit Parties	Lok Janshakti Party (Bihar), VPP (TN) — see above

"The Big 6 Solutions" to End Caste Discrimination

#	Solution	Details
1	Banish Untouchability in Educational Institutions	Government must pro-actively ensure a discrimination-free educational atmosphere
2	Land for All Rural Dalit Families	State governments should begin implementing the pledge of land reforms and provide pattas of land to all landless Dalits and additionally prevent any grabbing of Dalit-owned land by land mafia
3	Provide Viable Assets in Cities	Since most Dalits in urban areas are casual labourers in unorganized sectors, they should be made owners of viable assets they work on, like rickshaws
4	Ensure Food Security	Include all Dalit families in the Antyodaya Anna Yojana / Priority households in the National Food Security Act, 2013 . Food security must be doggedly pursued during droughts and floods.
5	Implement Sukhdeo Thorat Committee Report	Constitutionally guaranteed safeguards should be adhered to in order to prevent hostility against " students of reserved category "
6	Rehabilitate Manual Scavengers	Prohibition of Employment as Manual Scavengers and their Rehabilitation Act 2013 has not been enough. They must be given training in non-sanitary work .

CONSTITUTIONAL SAFEGUARDS FOR SCHEDULED CASTES

Key Differences from ST provisions: SCs suffer from extreme social, educational and economic backwardness arising from the **age-old practice of untouchability**. The safeguards are almost the same as for STs except: Art. **341** (not 342) for SC notification; Art. **366(24)** (not 25) for SC definition; Art. **17** — **Abolition of Untouchability** and prohibition of any such practices; **No Schedule V/VI** and no specific state features like Art. 164/371.

Art. 341 — SC Notification

- **Article 341** empowers the President to **notify** the "castes, races or tribes or parts of or groups within castes, races or tribes" that will be considered **as Scheduled Castes** in a state or UT
- For **states**, the President is also required to **consult with the Governor** before issuing the notification

Art. 366(24) — SC Definition

- Scheduled Castes means such castes, races or tribes or parts of or groups within such castes, races or tribes as are deemed under **Article 341** to be Scheduled Castes for the purposes of this Constitution

HOW SAFEGUARDS ARE WORKING

✓ SOCIAL SUCCESSES

- **Reservation Policies:** Constitutional provisions for **reservations in education and government jobs** have led to greater representation of SCs and STs
- **Legal Prohibitions:** Laws **prohibiting untouchability and discrimination** promote a more inclusive society

✗ SOCIAL CHALLENGES

- **Persistent Social Discrimination:** Despite laws, **social exclusion and atrocities** against SCs continue
- **Inadequate Awareness and Enforcement:** **Low awareness** and **weak enforcement** of anti-discrimination laws hinder social integration

✓ ECONOMIC SUCCESSES

- Policies promoting **reservations in entrepreneurship, employment, and land ownership** aim to improve the economic status

✗ ECONOMIC CHALLENGES

- **Economic disparities persist** and access to **resources and credit** remains limited
- **Inconsistent execution** of welfare and empowerment programs reduces their impact

✓ POLITICAL SUCCESSES

- **Reserved seats in Parliament, State Assemblies, and Panchayats** have ensured greater political representation

✗ POLITICAL CHALLENGES

- **Tokenism & marginalization:** Representation often remains **symbolic**, with **limited influence** on policy decisions
- SCs are **rarely found in top leadership positions**, affecting policy formulation and governance outcomes

Procedure for Inclusion in SC List

- 1 State Govt / UT Proposal
- 2 Review by **Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment (MoSJE)**
- 3 Examination by **Registrar General of India (RGI)**
- 4 Recommendation by **National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC)**
- 5 **Union Cabinet Approval**
- 6 **Presidential Notification**

OTHER BACKWARD CLASSES (OBCs)

Definition: This category is meant to include the whole of the **middle bands of caste and communities** situated **above the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes** excluding only the prominently well-advantaged groups at the top. OBCs are described as "**socially and educationally backward classes**".

OBC KEY FACTS

52% population (Mandal)

41% by 2006 (NSS)

27% reservation

Present in every state

Dynamic list maintained by MoSJE

Population & Distribution

- OBCs were found to comprise **52% of the country's population** by the **Mandal Commission report of 1980**, a figure which had shrunk or increased to **41% by 2006** when the **National Sample Survey** took place
- There is **substantial debate** over the exact number of OBCs; it is generally estimated to be sizable, but **many believe it is higher** than figures quoted by either Mandal or NSS
- Present all over India in every state**
- The list of OBCs maintained by the **Indian Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment** is **dynamic**, with castes and communities being added or removed depending on social, educational and economic factors

KEY COMMISSIONS

Commission	Year	Key Recommendation	Outcome
 Kalekar Commission (1st Backward Classes Commission)	1955	Recommended " caste as the criteria " to determine backwardness	Rejected by govt
 Mandal Commission (2nd Backward Classes Commission)	1980	27% reservation was recommended owing to the legal constraint that the total quantum of reservation should not exceed 50%	Implemented 1990
Justice G. Rohini Commission	2017	Sub-categorization of OBCs under Art. 340. Investigate inequitable distribution of reservation benefits among OBC castes/groups using the central OBC list as guide. Develop a scientific approach for sub-categorization.	Ongoing

ROHINI COMMISSION FINDINGS (DETAILED)

- Out of **2,633 OBCs** on central list, **~1,900 castes** have NOT benefited proportionately
- Half** of 1,900 got **zero benefits** from reservation; other half got **less than 3%**
- Only **10 sub-castes** received **25%** of OBC reservation advantages
- Profession-based castes like **Kalaigars** (tin polishers), **Sikligars & Saranias** (knife sharpeners) got almost **no benefits from reservations**
- 1,900 castes account for roughly 2% to 3% of total seats** — while a fixed quota will have little impact on other groups, it may provide major opportunities for them

Rohini Commission Data Tables

Share of OBC Reservation by Group

Number of OBC sub-castes

Percentage of benefit availed

10	24.95%
38	25.04%
102	25%
506	22.32%
994	2.68%
983	0%
Total 2,633	100%

Panel Suggestion: A fixed quota of 8 to 10% of the total OBC quota of 27% for around 1,900 castes from the central list of 2,633 OBCs. Also raised: **What about sub-categorisation of SC and ST communities? Think about it.. Form an informed opinion.**

CREAMY LAYER (DETAILED)

- **Definition:** The "creamy layer" is the generally **small section of people** that occupies the top of a marginalized community's socioeconomic hierarchy
- **Test:** A candidate must be below a certain **income ceiling** in order to avail reservation in government jobs and educational institutions
- **Origin:** Originally, reservation for Dalits, Adivasis and OBCs did not specify any income criteria. The **sole basis of reservation was caste**. It was the **Supreme Court** which brought in the concept in 1993 through its judgment in the **Indira Sawhney case**.
- **Supreme Court Quote:** "Exclusion of such socially advanced members," it argued, **"will make the 'class' a truly backward class."** Putting in the creamy layer framework was in keeping with the basic structure of the Constitution as it mapped to the principle of equality.
- **Scope:** The principle only applied to **Other Backward Classes, NOT Dalits and Adivasis**, who are acknowledged as the country's most backward communities.

Should Economic Criteria Apply to SC/ST Reservation?

- **Reservation is, by definition, a means to ending discrimination based on caste** which has been a feature of Indian society for thousands of years. It is **not a remedy for economic backwardness**.
- This is why there is **no reservation for low-income members of upper castes**. Reservation is meant to ensure that **backward castes are fairly represented** in public services, educational institutions and legislatures — something denied to them throughout Indian history.
- Many scholars argue that mandating an **economic ceiling for reservation misunderstands how caste works**: Dalits and Adivasis face discrimination **even if they are well-off or educated**.
- **Example:** In 2014, a temple in Bihar was reportedly cleaned and its idol washed after **Dalit CM Jitan Ram Manjhi** visited
- **Counter-argument:** Far from seats being cornered by a small clique, Dalits and Adivasis are **so disadvantaged** it is difficult to even fill the seats reserved for them. In July 2018, the highly sought-after **Delhi University did not manage to fill its reserved category seats**. This is true of government jobs as well.
- Placing further curbs to exclude the creamy layer will serve no purpose other than that **more valuable seats will go unfilled**

OBCs AMONG NON-HINDU COMMUNITIES

Muslims — Caste-Based Stratification

- Indian Muslims, too, are **victims of caste-based stratification** and are divided into **3 main classes** and 100s of biradaris:

Class	Meaning	Origin
Ashraf	The "nobles"	Trace ancestry to inhabitants of the Arab peninsula or Central Asia or are converts from Hindu upper castes
Ajlaf	The "commoners"	Said to be converted from Hindu low castes
Arzals	The "despicable"	Said to be Dalit converts

- **Savarna Muslims** constitute about **15% of the entire Muslim population** in India; the rest comprise backward, Dalit and tribal Muslims
- Example: **Mappilas of Kerala** — Muslim OBCs

Hindu-Muslim OBC Anomaly in Reservations

- **Problem:** The Hindu-Muslim anomaly in granting reservation to occupational communities. Eg: **Darzis (tailors), Dhunias (cotton carders) and Julahas (weavers)** in several states
- **Case Study:** Muslims who belong to such groups — for example, **Julahas in UP**, and **Dhunias and Darzis in Bihar** — have **got reservation in the central list of OBCs**, but Hindus from the same groups have been left out
- **Possible Solution:** The **Justice Rohini Commission** has compiled data on these religiously restricted entries and is likely to **recommend removal** of the anomaly to ensure that **backward class status is independent of religion**

Anti-Casteism Movements Among Muslims

The **1990s** saw the rise of several social movements to **abolish casteism** in Muslim society:

Organization	Leader	Location
All India Backward Muslim Morcha	Dr Ejaz Ali	National
All India Pasmanda Muslims Mahaj	Ali Anwar	Bihar
All India Muslim OBC Organisation	Shabbir Ansari	Maharashtra

Caste in Christianity (Detailed Case Study)

Persistence of Caste System among Indian Christians

Despite the egalitarian ideals of Christianity, the **caste system remains deeply embedded among Indian Christians**, particularly in **Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Goa, and North India**. Historical patterns of conversion often mirrored existing social hierarchies, and many converts retained their earlier caste identities even after baptism.

Kerala: **Syrian Christians (St. Thomas Christians)** consider themselves descendants of high-status converts evangelized by St. Thomas and historically practiced **caste-like purity rules**, including **ritual baths after contact with Dalits**. Lower-caste converts such as **Dalit Christians**, though part of the same faith, were often denied entry into Syrian Christian churches or had to **sit separately during mass**. Intermarriage between groups like **Knanaya, Nasrani, and Dalit Christians** remains rare.

Goa: The Portuguese attempted to suppress caste by assigning **Portuguese surnames** during conversion, but caste divisions persisted. Converts from Brahmin and merchant castes became **Bamonns and Chardos**, while those from lower castes were labeled **Sudirs**, reinforcing a stratified Christian hierarchy.

Tamil Nadu: Communities like **Paravar, Nadar, and Adi Dravida Christians** retain strong caste identities. Studies show that **Christian Nadars prefer marrying Hindu Nadars** over Christians of lower caste status.

North India: Dalit Christians descended from **Chuhra and Chamar converts** continue to face **occupational segregation** and are often referred to as **"New Christians,"** a term used derogatorily. Dalit Christians report **separate seating, restricted church entry, and exclusion from priesthood**.

This reveals that **caste consciousness and discrimination endure across religions**, demonstrating the **structural resilience of caste in Indian society**.

DEBATE ON NON-HINDU SCHEDULED CASTES

- In **January 2020**, the **Supreme Court** agreed to examine a petition seeking **"religion-neutral" SC reservations**
- The plea challenges **Paragraph 3 of the Constitution (Scheduled Castes) Order, 1950**, which limits SC status to Dalits belonging to **Hindu, Sikh, or Buddhist** faiths only, thereby excluding **Dalit Christians and Dalit Muslims**
- The petition argues that this restriction violates **Articles 14, 15, and 25** of the Constitution, since caste-based oppression and social exclusion persist among Dalits across all religions
- Several expert bodies have endorsed this view: The **Justice Ranganath Misra Commission (2007)** and the **National Commission for Minorities Report by Satish Deshpande and Geetika Bapna (2008)** both provided empirical evidence of caste discrimination among Dalit converts and recommended **extension of SC benefits irrespective of religion**

- In **2022**, the Union Government constituted a **three-member Commission headed by former Chief Justice K.G. Balakrishnan** to re-examine the issue of SC status for Dalit Christians and Dalit Muslims
- **Key Question:** Should **caste-based disadvantage, rather than religion**, determine eligibility for Scheduled Caste recognition in India?

OBC SAFEGUARDS: SUCCESSES vs CHALLENGES

✓ SUCCESSES

- **Social:** Recognized as distinct category following **Mandal Commission (1980)** and implementation in **1990**. **27% reservation** in central educational institutions and public employment (as per **Indra Sawhney judgment, 1992**)
- **Economic:** **NBCFDC, Stand-Up India, PMMY (MUDRA)** → supported self-employment & skill training. Many OBC groups entered the **urban informal sector and lower-middle economic strata**, improving their standard of living.
- **Political:** Rise of OBC-based parties — **Samajwadi Party (UP), RJD (Bihar), DMK (TN)** — gave OBCs a **collective political voice**; increased representation in Parliament, State Assemblies, and Panchayati Raj Institutions

✗ CHALLENGES

- **Social:** **Internal inequality** — benefits **unevenly distributed**, with the **"creamy layer"** cornering most advantages, while **Extremely Backward Classes (EBCs)** and **Most Backward Classes (MBCs)** remain underrepresented. **Caste prejudice** and limited **inter-caste acceptance** persist.
- **Economic:** Large section still depend on **low-income and informal occupations** with limited access to **credit, markets, and land ownership**. No **nationwide caste census after 1931** limits ability to accurately target economic policies.
- **Political:** **Elite capture** by dominant sub-castes (e.g., **Yadavs, Kurmis, Vokkaligas**) leaving smaller communities marginalized. Despite regional success, OBCs remain **underrepresented in national policy-making positions** and higher bureaucracy.

OBC Inclusion Procedure

Level	Steps
Central OBC List	1. State/UT Proposal to MoSJE → 2. Examination by NCBC (with anthropologist & economist inputs) → 3. Union Cabinet Approval → 4. Presidential Notification under Art. 342A(1)
State OBC List	1. Community/Govt Request → 2. Evaluation by State Backward Classes Commission (SBCC) → 3. State Cabinet & Legislature Approval (where required under state law) → 4. Governor's Notification

CHAPTER 7.2 — SOCIAL CHANGE IN TRIBAL SOCIETIES

SCHOLARS ON SOCIAL CHANGE

Anderson & Parker

"Social change involves **alteration** in the **structure** and **functioning** of **societal forms or processes** themselves."

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Surinder Jodhka

Social change = change in **values, institutions and practices**.

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Context: Tribal societies, like other societies, have also been **undergoing change**. **Colonial transformation** of the tribal society forms an important area of study. The main theme of the changes is **disturbance of the traditional tribal socio-economic system**.

SOCIAL CHANGE TIMELINE

Ancient: No change

Medieval: Less change

Colonial: More change

Post-Independence: Rapid change

PRE-INDEPENDENCE SOCIAL CHANGE

Causes of Social Change

- Introduction of **outsiders** in tribal areas
- Extension of **state authority** in tribal areas
- **Commercialisation of agriculture**
- **Hinduisation & Christianity** — Evangelisation
- **Ethnic revolts** and tribal movements

TRIBAL CLASSIFICATION BY CULTURAL PROCESS

B.K. Roy Burman (1970)

Classified tribes by **orientation towards Hindu society**. However, **he himself later disassociated** from this approach. This classification can still be used to understand the **socio-cultural situation of tribal communities in the pre-colonial or colonial set up** but not the social change.

Handwritten class annotation

Orientation	Description	Examples
Incorporated	Merged into Hindu society	Bhil, Bhumij
Positively Oriented	Moving towards Hindu society	Santhal, Oraons
Negatively Oriented	Resistant to Hindu society	Mizo, Naga
Indifferent	Unaffected by Hindu society	Tribals from Arunachal

L.P. Vidyarthi & S.C. Dube

In order to understand the **colonial and post-colonial situation**, they classified tribes based on different levels and stages of **ACCULTURATION** [assimilation towards the different culture, typically the dominant one] of **Hindu peasantry** in different regions of the country.

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SOCIAL CHANGES UNDERWENT: ECONOMY

Non-Monetised to Monetised

- Due to this, **tribal markets declined**
- **Reciprocity, Redistribution and socio-cultural exchange** were the bases of traditional tribal economy
- The traditional form of **barter exchange died away**
- There was some evidence that sections of the tribes took to **commodity production on a limited scale** (✍️ K.S. Singh)

Peasantization & Depeasantization

- During this period, **both processes operated at the same time**
- Several tribal communities who were **not peasants** were coming into the fold of **peasantry (Peasantization)**
- While a number of tribal people after **losing their land** were entering into a **different economic system (Depeasantization)**
- **Depeasantization** = a phenomenon where **small and marginal farmers are pushed out of the agricultural sector** due to being unable to sustain farming practices. And this process is **increasing**.
- Substantial sections of tribes from middle India such as **Santhals, Oraon and Munda** had to migrate to the **tea plantations of Assam** and the adjoining areas while others became **industrial labor, share-croppers** etc.

SOCIAL CHANGES: POLITY

- **Customary laws** → **regulating modern laws**
- The customary law of tribal communities was replaced by the **new law of the centralized state power** during British rule and this continued even after that
- The new law operated through its **administrative and judicial organs** and helped the process of Hinduisation to some extent

SOCIAL CHANGES: KINSHIP

- **Breakdown of kinship relations** due to alienation from their land and migration
- Adivasi communities are always dependent on **kin relationships** and community networks — they form the primary avenues of their **access to information, assistance during health problems** or sickness, **child care, economic assistance** along with several other social support systems
- Given this, the hardships of displacement exacerbate the **gendered burden of morbidities and mortality on the Adivasi women**

SOCIAL CHANGES: RELIGION

- **Indigenous religious beliefs** such as Animism, sacredness of sacred grooves etc. underwent **dilution**
- **Sanskritization**, conversions into Christians were common
- Christianity was perhaps the **earliest agency of welfare** in a number of tribal areas — but it took a back seat as an **ideology**
- The **modernizing role of Christian missions** is also an important feature of social change in tribal areas where it had a deep impact
- But unfortunately there always existed a **close link between Christianity and Colonialism**
- Under the impact of Christianity, a number of **values and institutions** of the affected tribal communities **wilted**:

Youth Dormitories: A very popular institution of tribes — their fate **declined** under Christianity. Obviously, the missionaries wanted the **churches only to be the places of congregation**, replacing the traditional dormitory system.

However: At the same time, Christianity also gave a **new sense of self-respect** to the tribal peasants and sought to create a **separate identity** for them.

ETHNIC CONFLICTS & TRIBAL MOVEMENTS

- Because of their **prolonged relative isolation**, tribal communities had developed their own **social structure** and **mechanism of social control** and they were **quite sensitive** to them
- This is why they reacted to changes more **strongly and often violently** than other populations
- Most tribal movements could be covered under the headings of '**Anti-Colonial**', '**Anti-Diku**' and '**Pro-Ethnic**'

K.S. Singh — 2 Phases of Ethnic Conflicts in Middle India

Phase 1 (1795-1860): Coincided with the rise, expansion and establishment of British empire. Examples: **Chuar rebellion** (1795-1800), **Kol** and **Bhumij** insurrections, Resistance by **Gond** zamindars (1819, 1842), **Khond resistance** (mid-1830s), **Santhal insurrection** (1855-59)

Phase 2 (1860-1920): Coincided with intensive phase of **colonialism**, much deeper penetration of tribal and peasant economies by **merchant capital**, **higher incidence of rent**. Examples: **Munda-Oraon Sardar Movement** (1869-1895) led by **Birsa Munda**, **Tana Bhagat Movement** (1895-1901), **Bhil's movement led by Govind Giri**

Surajit Sinha (1972) — 5 Types of Tribal Movements

1. Ethnic Rebellious Movements: During British rule in 18th & 19th centuries. E.g., Birsa movement among Mundas, Kol rebellion (1832), **Santhal Rebellion** (1855-56, led by **Sido and Kanhu** against zamindars and moneylenders; later turned **anti-British**), Naga rebellion (1880s)

2. Reform Movements: Emulating the pattern of higher Hindu castes. E.g., **Bhagat movement** among Oraon, Vaishnavite movement among Bhumij, **Kehr movement** among Santhals

3. Political Movements: For tribal states within the Indian Union in the post-Independence period. E.g., **Jharkhand movement** in Chotanagpur and Orissa, Hill states movement in Assam and MP

4. Secessionist Movements: E.g., **Naga and Mizo** movements

5. Agrarian Movements: E.g., **Naxalbari movement** (1967) and **Birsadal movement** (1968-69)

Sanskritization in Tribal Societies

- Tribal society moving closer to the **peasant/caste stratified system** — this strengthened the role of **sanskritization**
- Some tribes of central India unitedly **moved towards the Varna system** and laid their claim over **Kshatriya status** mainly because the **Kshatriya model of Sanskritization** was the **easiest** and most popular process
- **Example:** The **Santhals** and the **Gonds** followed the Sanskritization model, while few other tribes followed kshatriyazation

Summary: Colonial transformation profoundly altered tribal life. What began as limited contact turned into widespread economic dependence, displacement, and acculturation. The shift from **self-sufficient tribal systems to monetized, stratified, and state-controlled societies** marked one of the most significant phases of social change in India's tribal history.

SOCIAL CHANGE POST COLONIAL PERIOD

Context: In the post-colonial period, changes in tribal societies were due to the **social development and welfare schemes** taken up by the **independent Indian government**. Due to differences in different tribal societies, they gave **mixed reactions** to these schemes. Overall, the changes may be **positive as well as negative** with differences in their degree from one tribe to another and within the same tribe.

Chaudhary (1990)

Tribal Transformation in India (5 Vols.) — Highlights their unmatched plurality and points out **3 salient facets** of post-colonial change:

1. Transformation from **peripheral existence** to **awareness of civic rights**
2. The **development has not been up to expectations** (ST literacy 59% vs national 73% in Census 2011; NFHS-4: Under-5 mortality among tribals **57.2 per 1000** vs others 38.5; IMR: **44.4** vs 32.1)
3. **Elite class has emerged** through democratic institutions and has **cornered the developmental benefits**

Handwritten class annotation

Mr. Prabhu — Elite Capture

Dominant groups such as **Valmiki and the Naika communities** cornered all the developmental schemes. And the primitive tribes like **Jenu Kuruba and Soligas** are left in the lurch.

Findings of "The People of India Project" (Anthropological Survey of India)

- Many tribes were participating and contributing to the country; a few became **entrepreneurs, businessmen, teachers, political leaders**
- **Educational levels doubled** (8.53% to 16.35%) from 1961 to 1981
- **Literacy rate for STs improved from 47.1% in 2001 to 59% in 2011** (Census)
- Tribes avail health and medical facilities. **Decline in death rate and rise in birth rate**
- Coverage of **mass media** (radio and TV) in tribal areas has increased

CASE STUDIES — POST-COLONIAL CHANGE

Hunter-Gatherers

- Evidence that this group is **losing control over their means of subsistence** from the early part of colonial rule, forcing them to take to other survival strategies
- **Jenu Kurba** — with their vast traditional knowledge of forests, are now **helping the forest department** in rearing elephants and collection of forest produce
-  **Baviskar (1995)** — traced **criminality among the Bhil and the Bhilala** of Jhabua district, MP to the growing control of the State over the forest resources and degradation of cultivable lands
- Another study highlights the **failure of the Chenchu resettlement scheme**. As a result, they have **taken to crime** in certain areas

Artisans

-  **Gadgil & Guha (1992)** — Certain artisan activities declining: **Blacksmithing is declining**; the **Agarias and Asurs** took up **agriculture**. The **availability of raw materials** for other crafts like **basketry** and the **high price charged for bamboo** by the **forest department** has contributed to the impoverishment of tribals
- Another study of the **Dhokda crafts** among the **Dhurva of Madhya Pradesh** also points out similar drawbacks — particularly the **deficiencies in government schemes** related to training, supply of tool-kits and marketing

Shifting Cultivators

- This group was hit hard due to the **Government forest policies**. The alternative activities like Animal husbandry, Plantation etc. started to gain prominence
- **Example:** A class of **landless agricultural workers** has emerged as a result of the **taking over of Jhum lands by the forest department**. These people now are **wage earners in the plantations**

Settled Agriculturists

- Tribals started adopting new methods like **line sowing and manure pits**
- 🖋️ **Mahapatra's** study on the **Santhals** points out that out of eight Santhal sub-groups, the **Murmu (priest), the Mardi and the Tudu** who are most **influential and landed** have **gained the most** through the planning process, depriving the other groups

Modern Democratic Institutions: Panchayats

- The **positive impact** of modern political institutions includes **greater representation and recognition of tribal rights**
- The **negative impact** includes **conflict arising from modern governance structures that clash with traditional political institutions**, and the undermining of traditional Panchayats
- The **People of India study, discussing the Gond**, points out that **no clash** was observed between the Traditional Panchayat and the statutory panchayats:
 - While **Statutory panchayats** are active in village **politics** and close to power structure
 - Most of the **traditional panchayats** have restricted their activities to deciding civil disputes like **marital disputes**
 - **So both coexist now.**

Summary: Post-Independence **development efforts brought both progress and disparity** among tribal communities. While **education, health, and political participation** improved, uneven implementation and elite capture meant that **many vulnerable groups remained marginalized**, showing that social change has been **uneven and incomplete**.

CHAPTER 9.1 — DEVELOPMENTAL PROGRAMMES & WELFARE MEASURES

Context: The government is continuously trying to improve the life and livelihood of tribal people. As a part of this effort, many schemes were launched.

1. TRIBAL SUB-PLAN (TSP) — 1974

What is TSP?

- Introduced in **1974** to provide for **financial allocations in proportion to the ST population**
- Hence, the Union government should **earmark about 8.6%** (as per Census 2011) of the total central plan budget as TSP

4 Objectives of TSP

#	Objective
1	To reduce poverty and unemployment of the Tribals
2	To eradicate the exploitation and develop the remote areas
3	To improve the life by providing adequate health and educational services
4	TSP funds can also be utilized to address bottlenecks affecting access to nutrition, health and other civic services in tribal areas

Key Features of TSP

- Proposed on the basis that **no development is possible without the elimination of exploitation** in any field
- There are **30 Central Ministries/Departments**, and **23 States and 4 UTs** having specific fund allocation obligations for TSP
- Central Ministries and Departments are obligated for earmarking of TSP funds as per percentage prescribed by the **Ministry of Finance**
- TSP funds are to be **non-divertible and non-lapsable**
- TSP is **not applicable** to states where tribals represent **more than 60% of the population**

BD Sharma's Contribution

The late **BD Sharma**, instrumental in shaping government policies for tribals, asserted that "**Fifth Schedule** (of the Constitution — dealing with administration of Scheduled Areas and STs) and the **Tribal Subplan** are two **co-equal pillars of tribal empowerment**."

UN Dhebar Commission (1961)

The TSP was first presented as the magic solution by the **UN Dhebar Commission (1961)** in response to the government managing **massive tribal unrest in central-eastern India** due to **land alienation, poverty, indebtedness, and exploitation by non-tribal dominant groups**.

Case Study: TSP Budget Gap

TSP Budget Allocation vs Requirement

An allocation of **₹89,265.12 crore** in the Union Budget, which accounts for **only 2.26%** of the total expenditure, is far **below the 8.6% allocation** needed according to the estimates of the 2011 census, so that allocations were proportionate to the population of STs in the country.

2. EKALAVYA MODEL RESIDENTIAL SCHOOLS

- Objective:** To provide quality middle and high level education to STs, enabling them to avail reservation and access best educational opportunities

- It is a **Centrally Sponsored Scheme** and the schools will be at par with **Navodaya Vidyalayas**
- Every block having **more than 50% tribal population** and at least **20,000 tribal people** will have a school
- **Centers of excellence** with **state of art infrastructure** will be set up for **skill development, sports training**
- **100% grant in aid** from **Ministry of Tribal Affairs**

3. VANBANDHU KALYAN YOJANA

- **Objectives:** Improving **quality of life** in tribal areas; Providing better quality **education**; Improving and providing quality **infrastructure**; To protect the **rich culture and heritage** of tribals
- It is a **central scheme** covering tribes across the country
- This scheme **oversees the other central and state schemes** covered under the respective Tribal Sub Plans

4. MFP-MSP SCHEME (Minor Forest Produce through Minimum Support Price)

- **Objective:** To ensure that MFP gatherers receive **reasonable rewards**, primarily through MSP for identifiable MFP gathered by them, as well as the necessary infrastructure at the local level
- Designed to improve the livelihood of MFP gatherers by providing them **fair price**
- Implemented in **21 states** across the country

5. PRADHAN MANTRI VAN DHAN YOJANA (PMVDY)

- **Objectives:** Upgradation of **skill and capacity building training**; Setting up on **primary processing and value addition facility**
- Part of the MFP-MSP scheme
- The plan is to establish tribal community-owned **Van Dhan Vikas Kendras (VDVKs)** in tribal forest regions
- A Kendra shall consist of **15 tribal SHGs**, each comprising up to **20 tribal NTFP gatherers or artisans**
- **100% Central Government Funded**
- SHGs would be provided operational space by **panchayats and district administration**
- Training in **Value addition, Use of equipment, Enterprise Management**
- Identification of local, district level, state level, national, global buyers for MFP **Value Added Products**
- Arrangement for **Logistics & Transportations, Branding & Marketing**

6. INTEGRATED TRIBAL DEVELOPMENT PROJECTS (ITDP)

- The **Programme on ITDP under TSP** has been implemented since the **Fifth Five Year Plan** with specific objectives of **reducing poverty, improving educational status and eliminating exploitation** of tribal families
- The programme was **evaluated by the Programme Evaluation Organisation (PEO) in 1996** to assess effectiveness and performance of planning, monitoring, and impact on the well-being of STs. Report released July 1997.

PEO Findings (Detailed)

- Though administrative arrangements existed in all states as per Central guidelines, the system of **decentralized planning, implementation and monitoring** was **not operational** in most states
- The **delivery system of the programme was not effective** — a very large number of tribal farmers were found to use **irrigation water, High Yielding Variety (HYV) seeds, fertilizers and other inputs from private sources**, even though a significant proportion of funds were being spent on **free delivery** of such inputs
- **Inadequate facilities for primary education and health** were also observed
- **Suggestion:** ITDP **Project Officers** should be made **more effective** in planning and implementation. It is also necessary to assess the deprivation of tribes in all areas of social concern for adoption of an appropriate principle for determining the size of TSP and allocation of funds across various sectors. This must be backed by a **strong monitoring mechanism**.

7. "FRIENDS OF TRIBES" INITIATIVE

- Under this initiative, **TRIFED** has tied up **CSR funds** to promote tribal livelihoods
- To create awareness and promote **tribal arts and crafts** as well as help in socio-economic welfare
- Products available under **Tribes India brand** & outlets could be procured through online retailers like **Amazon, Flipkart**, etc.

8. TRIFED (Tribal Cooperative Marketing Development Federation of India)

- Established in **1987** under the **Ministry of Tribal Affairs** as a **national-level cooperative body**
- Core objective: To promote the **socio-economic development of Scheduled Tribes** through marketing support, value addition, and capacity building. To ensure **fair and remunerative prices** for MFP and handicrafts
- Under the **MSP for MFP Scheme**, TRIFED acts as the **nodal agency** for procurement, preventing exploitation by middlemen and stabilizing tribal incomes
- Through the **Van Dhan Vikas Yojana (VDVY)**, it promotes **value addition, entrepreneurship, and skill training** among tribal gatherers by forming VDVVs and clusters across India
- TRIFED also manages **"Tribes India" retail outlets**, e-commerce platforms, and exhibitions such as **Aadi Mahotsav**, which showcase tribal art, textiles, and crafts nationally and internationally
- Works closely with **state-level federations, NGOs, and self-help groups** to strengthen local supply chains and promote sustainable livelihoods

WADI Programme (NABARD)

WADI — NABARD-funded Tribal Development Programme (TDP)

Impact: **5,394 acres** of land promoted; **5,550 families** benefited. 5,500 Tribal Marginal farmers have seen a significant increase in their average yearly income from **₹20,000 to ₹30,000**. The increased multi-cropping system followed in WADI has achieved **food & nutritional security** for families. **Increased involvement and active participation** of various stakeholders viz development institutions, tribals, financial institutions.

IMPLEMENTATION CHALLENGES: 7 TSP CHALLENGES (Planning Commission, 2013)

The Planning Commission in 2013 got a holistic evaluation study conducted through a third party agency on the effectiveness of the TSP strategy. The prominent reasons for underperformance of TSP funds identified:

#	Challenge	Details
1	Lack of Unified Planning, Implementation & Monitoring	Multiple ministries and departments execute schemes independently, without a single nodal agency to coordinate. Leads to duplication, fragmented accountability, delays in multi-sectoral interventions like education, health and livelihood development.
2	Weak Convergence between Central and State Plan TSP Funds	Absence of a synchronized framework to integrate Central and State-level TSP allocations. Results in overlapping projects and inefficient fund utilization. Many states treated TSP as an accounting formality , diverting funds to general schemes without specific tribal focus.
3	Scattered Financial Resources & Fragmented Utilization	Funds thinly spread across numerous small projects , reducing their transformative potential. Short-term or symbolic initiatives dominate instead of sustained long-term investments.
4	Absence of Location-Specific Perspective Planning	TSP lacks context-sensitive micro-planning for the ecological, cultural, and socio-economic diversity of tribal regions. Uniform program designs imposed on heterogeneous tribal areas, ignoring specific needs of PVTGs, forest-dependent communities, or pastoral tribes .
5	Lack of Systematic Gap Analysis	No comprehensive baseline assessment to identify development deficits between tribal and non-tribal populations. TSP allocations are not evidence-based; priorities like education, healthcare, livelihood remain misaligned with ground realities .
6	Weakening of Institutions	Institutions specifically meant for delivery to tribals — i.e. ITDA / ITDP / Tribal Research Institutes (TRI) and other Micro Projects — have weakened.
7	Misuse of TSP Funds	TSP funds actually used in forcing tribal displacement for mining; building highways for mineral transport ; worst cases include purchasing choppers and repairing jail buildings in Jharkhand

Conclusion: Despite significant financial allocations, **ineffective coordination, poor convergence, and lack of localized planning** have limited the TSP's impact, calling for **institutional reform, data-driven planning, and greater accountability** in tribal welfare governance.

WAY FORWARD FOR TRIBAL DEVELOPMENT

- It's important to involve all stakeholders — not only **administrators**, but also **anthropologists**, and most importantly the **tribals themselves** in order to adopt a **felt-needs approach**
- As **Verrier Elwin** urged, tribal development must let communities grow "**according to their own genius**"
- As **L.P. Vidyarthi** reminded, it should balance **material progress** with **cultural happiness**, ensuring empowerment through **culturally sensitive, participatory, and rights-based approaches**

SCHOLAR REFERENCE TABLE

Scholar	Contribution	Topic
National R&R Policy, 2007	Minimize displacement; rehabilitation = holistic restoration	Ch 6.3 — R&R
K.R. Saxena 	Compiled NHRC stats: 37% BPL, 54% undernourished, crime every 18 min	Ch 7.1 — SC
Ajit Donker & Saxena (2012) 	93% board seats = upper castes; 3.8% backward; 3.5% SC/ST	Ch 7.1 — SC
Sukhdeo Thorat Committee 	Educational institution discrimination; "Big 6 Solutions"	Ch 7.1 — SC
Justices Chandrachud & Nagarathna (2021)	"Atrocities against SCs & STs are not a thing of the past"	Ch 7.1 — SC
Lokur Committee (1965)	5 criteria for ST identification (now obsolete)	Ch 7.1 — ST
Hrusikesh Panda Task Force (2014)	5 new criteria; Lokur criteria "obsolete, rigid & condescending"	Ch 7.1 — ST
Kalekar Commission (1955) 	Caste as criteria; rejected by government	Ch 7.1 — OBC
Mandal Commission (1980) 	27% reservation; total should not exceed 50%	Ch 7.1 — OBC
Justice G. Rohini (2017)	Sub-categorization; 1,900 of 2,633 OBCs left out; 10 sub-castes cornered 25%	Ch 7.1 — OBC
Indira Sawhney case (1993)	Creamy layer concept; "Exclusion of socially advanced members will make the 'class' a truly backward class"	Ch 7.1 — OBC
J. Ranganath Misra Commission (2007)	Religion-neutral SC reservations	Ch 7.1 — OBC/SC
Deshpande & Bapna (2008)	Empirical evidence of caste discrimination among Dalit converts	Ch 7.1 — OBC
Justice K.G. Balakrishnan (2022)	Re-examining SC status for Dalit Christians & Muslims	Ch 7.1 — OBC
Anderson & Parker 	Social change = alteration in structure & functioning of societal forms	Ch 7.2 — Pre-Colonial
Surinder Jodhka 	Social change = change in values, institutions and practices	Ch 7.2 — Pre-Colonial
B.K. Roy Burman (1970) 	4 orientations to Hindu society (incorporated/positive/negative/indifferent)	Ch 7.2 — Pre-Colonial
L.P. Vidyarthi & S.C. Dube 	Acculturation levels of Hindu peasantry in different regions	Ch 7.2 — Pre-Colonial
Surajit Sinha (1972) 	5 types of tribal movements (rebellious/reform/political/secessionist/agrarian)	Ch 7.2 — Pre-Colonial
K.S. Singh 	2 phases of ethnic conflicts; barter to commodity production	Ch 7.2 — Pre-Colonial
Chaudhary (1990) 	<i>Tribal Transformation in India</i> (5 Vols.); 3 facets of change; elite capture	Ch 7.2 — Post-Colonial
Mr. Prabhu 	Dominant Valmiki & Naika cornered schemes; Jenu Kuruba & Soligas left behind	Ch 7.2 — Post-Colonial
Baviskar (1995) 	Criminality among Bhil & Bhilala (Jhabua, MP) linked to state forest control	Ch 7.2 — Hunter-Gatherers
Gadgil & Guha (1992) 	Artisan decline; Agarias & Asurs shifted to agriculture; bamboo price issues	Ch 7.2 — Artisans
Mahapatra 	Santhal study: Murmu, Mardi, Tudu sub-groups cornered planning benefits	Ch 7.2 — Settled Agriculturists
BD Sharma	5th Schedule + TSP = "co-equal pillars of tribal empowerment"	Ch 9.1 — TSP

UN Dhebar Commission (1961)	Proposed TSP in response to massive tribal unrest due to land alienation, poverty, indebtedness	Ch 9.1 — TSP
Planning Commission (2013)	7 TSP challenges identified through third-party evaluation	Ch 9.1 — TSP
PEO (1996)	ITDP evaluation: delivery system not effective; tribal farmers buying inputs from private sources despite free delivery budgeted	Ch 9.1 — ITDP
Verrier Elwin	Let communities grow "according to their own genius"	Ch 9.1 — Way Forward
L.P. Vidyarthi	Balance material progress with cultural happiness	Ch 9.1 — Way Forward

QUICK-REVISION CHEAT SHEET

Last-Minute Exam Scanner — L-63 Tribal India (Ch 6.3, 7.1, 7.2, 9.1)

TOPIC	KEY SCHOLARS	KEY CASE STUDIES	MAIN POINTERS & EXAMPLES	TRIGGER KEYWORDS
6.3 R&R	• National R&R Policy, 2007 • Eminent domain	• Hirakud Dam — 22,000 families • Baiga & Gond — Kanha (2015) • Mysuru Adivasi (2020) — 210 families • Rourkela Steel (1956) — land-for-land • Ho community — Zinc Factory	7 Issues: Land ID, land records (Patwari/30 yrs), PAP ID, loss of livelihood (style of earning), loss of home (ecological incompatibility), stakeholder exclusion, no grievance redressal Resettlement = spatial (where) vs Rehabilitation = holistic (how) Solutions: Land-for-land (best); Self-employment (12 types incl. carpet weaving, apiculture, sericulture); Project employment 6 Resettlement Factors: livelihood, market, health/education, fodder/grain space, expansion space, community land PAPs reject fully-built colonies	PAPs (50-100M) • eminent domain • Patwari records • ecological incompatibility • empathy not sympathy • land-for-land • involuntary displacement • depeasantization
7.1 ST Constitutional	• Lokur Committee (1965) — 5 criteria • Hrusikesh Panda (2014) — 5 new criteria • BD Sharma — 5th Schedule + TSP	• Chenchu PVTG bonded labour (2018) • Paniya, Kattunayakan, Adiya child labour (2023) — CPI(Maoist) link	Lokur 5: Primitive traits, distinctive culture, geo isolation, shyness, backwardness Panda 5 New: Socio-economic backwardness, historical isolation, distinct language, core cultural identity, endogamy — assessed holistically 5th Schedule: Art. 244(1), TAC 6th Schedule: Art. 244(2), 4 NE states, ADCs Key Articles: 342, 366(25), 338A, 330/332, 243D/T, 164(1), 371(A/B/C/F) NFHS: IMR 62.1 → 41.6; Delivery 17.7% → 82.3%	Art. 342/366(25) • Lokur vs Panda • 5th & 6th Schedule • TAC • NCST • FRA 2006 • SC/ST PoA Act • Art. 371
7.1 SC Exploitation	• K.R. Saxena  • Donker & Saxena (2012)  • Thorat Committee  • Chandrachud & Nagarathna (2021)	• Gunnaur UP (2016) — water denial • Sunita (2022) — midday meal boycott • Rajeshwari TN (2020) — forced on floor • Aathupakkam TN (2023) — flag denied • Jitan Ram Manjhi (2014) — temple washed	6 Forms of Untouchability (detailed) Social factors: Caste system, ritual purity, Vedas ban, psychological inferiority Economic: UP 41K/46K leather workers (Chamars); Rajasthan 52K/76K sweepers (Bhangi) Political: 93% upper caste boards; backlash Other causes: reservation backlash, demolition, theft charges, misusing officials, illicit relations, drainage disputes Current: Rohit Vemula; Bhim Sena (militant); BSP/LJP/VPP (electoral) Art. 341 (not 342); Art. 366(24) (not 25); Art. 17 = abolition Big 6 Solutions	Crime/18 min • Art. 341/366(24)/17 • ritual purity • chandalas • SC/ST PoA Act • bonded labour • Bhim Sena • MUDRA • Bhopal Declaration • manual scavengers • No Schedule V/VI for SCs
7.1 OBCs	• Kalekar (1955)  • Mandal (1980)  • Justice Rohini (2017) • Indira Sawhney (1993) • Ranganath Misra	• Mappilas — Muslim OBCs • Julahas/Dhunias/Darzis — Hindu-Muslim anomaly • Kalaigars/Sikligars/Saranias	OBCs = 52% pop (Mandal), 41% (NSS); dynamic list by MoSJE Rohini: 2,633 OBCs; 1,900 left out; 10 sub-castes cornered	52% pop • 27% reservation • creamy layer • Art. 340/342A • sub-categorization • 2,633 OBCs • 1,900 left out •

(2007)
• **Balakrishnan** (2022)

— zero benefits
• **Syrian Christians** — purity rules, ritual baths
• **Goa:** Bamonns/Chardos vs Sudirs
• **DU 2018** — unfilled reserved seats
• **Jitan Ram Manjhi** temple cleaned

25%; suggested 8-10% fixed quota
Creamy layer = income ceiling (OBC only, NOT SC/ST); Indira Sawhney 1993; reservation = ending caste discrimination, not economic backwardness
Muslims: Ashraf/Ajlaf/Arzals; savarna = 15%
Christians: Kerala Syrian Christians = purity rules; TN Paravar/Nadar retain caste; North India Chuhra/Chamar = "New Christians" — separate seating, restricted church entry, exclusion from priesthood
Debate: Para 3 SC Order 1950 limits SC to Hindu/Sikh/Buddhist; Art. 14, 15, 25 violation argument
OBC parties: SP, RJD, DMK
Elite capture: Yadavs, Kurmis, Vokkaligas

Ashraf/Ajlaf/Arzals •
Pasmanda • religion-neutral SC • Para 3 SC Order 1950

7.2 Pre-Independence

• **Anderson & Parker**
• **Surinder Jodhka**
• **Roy Burman** (1970)
• **Vidarthi & Dube**
• **Surajit Sinha** (1972)
• **K.S. Singh**

• **Santhal Rebellion** (Sido & Kanhu, 1855-56)
• **Birsa Munda** (1869-1895)
• **Govind Giri** — Bhil movement
• **Santhals, Oraon, Munda** — Assam tea migration

Causes: Outsiders, state authority, commercialization, Hinduisation/Christianity, ethnic revolts
Roy Burman 4 types: Incorporated (Bhil), Positive (Santhal), Negative (Mizo), Indifferent (Arunachal)
Sinha 5 movements: Ethnic rebellious, Reform (Bhagat/Kehr), Political (Jharkhand), Secessionist (Naga/Mizo), Agrarian (Naxalbari 1967)
K.S. Singh 2 phases: Phase 1 (1795-1860): Chuar, Kol, Santhal; Phase 2 (1860-1920): Munda-Oraon, Tana Bhagat, Bhil
Economy: Barter → monetized; peasantization+depeasantization simultaneously; tribal markets declined
Kinship: Breakdown due to land alienation; kin = avenues for info, health, childcare, economic help; gendered burden on Adivasi women
Religion: Christianity = earliest welfare agency but linked to colonialism; youth dormitories declined (churches replaced); new sense of self-respect & separate identity
Polity: Customary → centralized state law
Sanskritization: Santhals & Gonds followed Kshatriya model (easiest & most popular)

Acculturation •
Sanskritization • Kshatriya model • anti-Colonial/anti-Diku/pro-Ethnic •
peasantization •
depeasantization • youth dormitories • Christianity = earliest welfare agency • kinship breakdown

7.2 Post-Colonial

• **Chaudhary** (1990)
• **Mr. Prabhu**
• **Baviskar** (1995)
• **Gadgil & Guha** (1992)
• **Mahapatra**

• **Jenu Kuruba** — helping forest dept
• **Bhil & Bhilala** (Jhabua) — criminality
• **Chenchu** resettlement failure → crime
• **Dhurva** — Dhokda crafts failed
• **Gond** — traditional + statutory panchayats coexist

People of India Project (ASI): Education doubled (8.53% → 16.35%); ST literacy 47.1% → 59% (2001-11); tribes became entrepreneurs, teachers, leaders; death rate declined; mass media increased
Chaudhary 3 facets: Peripheral → civic rights awareness; development below

People of India Project • elite capture • uneven development • ST literacy 59% • NFHS-4 • artisan decline • Jhum lands • statutory vs traditional panchayats • progress + disparity

• **Jhum lands** → wage earners in plantations

expectations; elite cornered benefits
NFHS-4: Under-5 mortality: tribal 57.2 vs others 38.5; IMR: 44.4 vs 32.1
ST literacy: 59% vs national 73% (Census 2011)
Hunter-gatherers: Losing subsistence; Baviskar = Bhil criminality from forest loss; Chenchu resettlement failure → crime
Artisans: Gadgil & Guha = blacksmithing declining; Agarias/Asurs → agriculture; bamboo price by forest dept
Shifting cultivators: Jhum lands taken by forest dept → landless → wage earners in plantations
Settled: Mahapatra = Santhal Murmu/Mardi/Tudu cornered planning benefits
Panchayats: Statutory = village politics; Traditional = marital disputes; both coexist (Gond study)

9.1 Developmental Programmes

- **BD Sharma** — co-equal pillars
- **UN Dhebar** (1961) — proposed TSP
- **Planning Commission** (2013) — 7 challenges
- **PEO** (1996) — ITDP evaluation
- **Verrier Elwin** — "own genius"
- **L.P. Vidyarthi** — material + cultural balance

- **TSP Budget Gap:** ₹89,265 cr = 2.26% (vs 8.6%)
- **WADI (NABARD):** 5,394 acres; 5,550 families; ₹20K → 30K
- **TSP Misuse:** choppers, jail repairs (JH), mining highways
- **TRIFED + Aadi Mahotsav**

8 Schemes: TSP (1974), Ekalavya, Vanbandhu Kalyan, MFP-MSP, PM Van Dhan Yojana (VDVKs), ITDP, Friends of Tribes, TRIFED (1987)
TSP 4 Objectives: Reduce poverty/unemployment; eradicate exploitation/develop remote areas; improve life via health/education; address bottlenecks in nutrition/health/civic services
TSP Key Features: No development without elimination of exploitation; 30 ministries + 23 states + 4 UTs; earmarking per MoF %; non-divertible & non-lapsable; NOT for states >60% tribal
Dhebar 1961: Response to massive tribal unrest due to land alienation, poverty, indebtedness, exploitation
Ekalavya: At par with Navodaya; blocks >50% & 20K+ tribal; centers of excellence; skill/sports; 100% central grant
TRIFED: Est. 1987, MoTA; nodal for MSP-MFP; VDVks = 15 SHGs x 20 gatherers; Tribes India outlets + e-commerce
ITDP PEO findings: Delivery not effective; tribals buying inputs privately despite free delivery budgeted; Project Officers need to be more effective
7 TSP Challenges (detailed above)
Way Forward: Felt-needs; culturally sensitive; participatory; involve anthropologists + tribals

TSP (1974) • 8.6% earmark • non-divertible • co-equal pillars • Dhebar 1961 • Ekalavya • Vanbandhu Kalyan • MFP-MSP • VDVks • ITDP • TRIFED (1987) • felt-needs • culturally sensitive • rights-based

MUST-REMEMBER NUMBERS

50-100M

PAPs displaced

22,000

Hirakud families

18 min

Dalit crime frequency

93%

Upper caste board seats

52%

OBC population (Mandal)

27%

OBC reservation

2,633

Total OBCs on central list

1,900

Underrepresented OBC castes

59%

ST literacy (2011)

57.2

Tribal under-5 mortality (per 1000)

8.6%

TSP budget earmark

2.26%

Actual TSP allocation

TOP QUOTABLE LINES FOR ANSWERS

- **Verrier Elwin:** Let communities grow "according to their own genius"
- **Supreme Court (2021):** "Atrocities against SCs & STs are not a thing of the past"
- **Indira Sawhney (1993):** "Exclusion of socially advanced members will make the 'class' a truly backward class"
- **R&R Principle:** People need **empathy**, not sympathy. Restoration of livelihood is not merely monetary — it's restoring the *process* of earning.
- **BD Sharma:** Fifth Schedule & TSP = "co-equal pillars of tribal empowerment"
- **Panda Committee:** Lokur criteria are "obsolete, rigid & condescending"
- **Colonial transformation:** Shift from self-sufficient tribal systems to monetized, stratified, state-controlled societies
- **Reservation debate:** Reservation is a means to ending caste discrimination, not a remedy for economic backwardness
- **Post-colonial summary:** Development efforts brought both progress and disparity — social change has been uneven and incomplete
- **TSP conclusion:** Despite significant financial allocations, ineffective coordination, poor convergence, and lack of localized planning have limited the TSP's impact